Response to PDF 026-10-04 Questions for Peter Combat Rules.

Note this is all for the current fighting rules, not the latest reformulated fighting rules (WIP) at:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1kwWdsJlAB99vcxwX2Sja38c5P2dkFFzmTs9E3Yjceic/edit?usp=sharing

Section A

A1 Agree

"One or two creatures per side in a match. **Two against two is not allowed.** The player must engage every stranger a free fighter could fight before sending two against one."

Just strange wording. The final sentence is true.

A2 Agree

A3 Agree

A4 With regard to the Magic Sword, "Man Woman or Hero" should read "Hero, Woman Hero, Man, Woman or Thief" because of "uses artefacts as" and "has the capabilities of". With regard to the Demon "any Axe bearer" should be clarified to be explicit "Hero, Woman Hero, Man, Woman, Thief or Dwarf"

A5 Agree

A6 "Blank in the ally column" indicates that the game is using old version of the Consolidated Rules. The latest version removes the reference tables to a separate document, and splits the "who can use" table into one for allies, one for strangers. 2026-10-05

A7 Agree

Corrected in the latest Consolidated Rules 2026-10-05.

A8 Surprise-attack bonus can be 0, 1 or 2. In the first round only.

Surprise Attack is obscure currently. I have written **Procedure: Determining Surprise Attack,** included in the latest reformulated fighting rules.

A9 Ending a fight is now comprehensively covered in the latest reformulated fighting rules.

A10 Agree

A11 Agree. (Assuming that "strongest fights strongest" means that each party nominates its "strongest" creature, and a fight follows employing the same fight procedure as for Quarrel.)

A12 Agree

Section B.

1. The attacker role.

"The party re-enters a chamber it retreated from" is problematic. See **Procedure: Determining Surprise Attack**

Swapping roles each round.

My mistake. This has been removed from the latest reformulated fighting rules.

2. Persistence of matches. Agree

3. Casualties when the strangers lose.

Again, my mistake. I failed to spot that inverting the required rolls would upset the Ring bonus mechanism. Strangers must roll high to get their choice, else strangers with the ring would be penalised. I initially thought that giving the selection to the human player would help, but it doesn't it just opens up the possibility of an exploit, where the human chooses the *weakest* to die, knowing that with a ring bonus, 4,5,6,or 7 will select the other creature. Not good. For now it is better to roll normally, add any ring bonus, and have 4,5,6,7 select the weaker (by strength) creature to die, choosing randomly to resolve a tie. I hope in the future that a decision required on stranger casualties could be covered in a **Fight Plan**.

4. Defender minimum deployment.

In the reformulated fighting rules 2026-10-05 **[Step c] Defender Prepares Their Defense,** we have the (much clearer, and compatible with PvP) "*The defender must attempt to deploy at least as many creatures as the attacker has unengaged creatures.*" This means (for example) a defender who outnumbers their attackers can keep fighters out of the fight if he wishes, and/or magic users. It is only necessary to strive to meet all potential attacker frontline creatures at least one-to-one. This would allow a defender party outnumbering the attacker to (for example) keep a Dwarf ring-bearer out of the fight for the first round – but the Ring still affects all die rolls.

5. The Scroll

Roles don't alternate. My mistake. The attacker is the party that initiated the fight by attacking or surprise- attacking.

6. Consumables when strangers attack.

Agree – Default.

7. The stranger loadout.

No, not what was intended. Artefact Loadout should only happen before the first round of a fight. Artefacts dropped by the dead during the fight stay on the floor. (The rationale is that it is suicidal to stop fighting in order to try to pick something up from the floor.)

8. Stranger Fight Preparations.

The intention was that a Fight Plan would eventually be able to deliver to the stranger party a

decision for every possible stage in a fight (or preparing to fight) where a human player would be required to make a decision. So, when the Fight Plan procedures are fully specified, a stranger party can call upon the Fight Plan for:

- A loadout plan for artefacts.
- A deployment decision.
- Nominating a stranger casualty.

How strangers allocate themselves.
Point for debate. With latest information supplied, I currently favour Monte Carlo simulation with a cutoff such that the human player does not notice any delay, and the game is “realistic” in that the longer the human player takes to decide their tactics, the longer the stranger have to decide theirs.

Loose ends in the loadout document.

Step 5 Wording – Agree

The Staff bonus – Agree

A transcription point – Agree. My mistake.